



PREPOSITIONS

The words that show position, time or direction

1 What is it?

Prepositions (prep-uh-ZISH-unz)

A preposition is a word that shows the relationship between a noun (or pronoun) and other words in a sentence — often about place, time or direction.

links a noun to the rest of the sentence

2 See it in action

Place

"The keys are **under** the sofa, **near** the door."

Time

"We'll meet **before** lunch and **after** the match."

Direction

"She walked **towards** the exit and **through** the gate."

Relationship

"This gift is **for** you, **from** all of us."



Keep going!

Underline every preposition in a paragraph and notice how many small words are quietly doing a big job.

3 More to know

Compound preposition

"He sat **next to** her, **in front of** the screen."

With a pronoun

"This letter is **from** her, addressed **to** him."

FUN FACT

English has around 150 prepositions in total, but just nine of them — of, in, to, for, with, on, at, from, by — make up over 90% of all preposition use in everyday writing.

4 Why it's used

Prepositions help: link nouns and pronouns to the rest of a sentence, showing exactly where, when, or how something relates to something else.

A preposition is always followed by a noun or pronoun (called the "object of the preposition") – "under the table", "with her".



You got this!

A preposition is always followed by a noun or pronoun – if nothing follows it, check you've used the right word.

5 Where you'll spot it

Common prepositions

in, on, at, under, over, between, through, beside, during, since, until.

Always followed by a noun

A preposition never stands alone – it always introduces a noun, pronoun, or noun phrase right after it.

⚠ Watch out!

The old classroom rule "never end a sentence with a preposition" is largely outdated – "Who did you go with?" is completely natural, correct English.

6 Quick recap

Shows place/time/direction

Followed by a noun

Links parts of a sentence



Think about...

Don't stress about ending a sentence with a preposition – in modern English, it's usually fine and often sounds more natural.